to be more prescient in refusing to relax political controls in order to ensure the survival of the one-party Leninist state. It was Gorbachev's perestroika that led to a dead end and the unravelling of the Soviet state.

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As expected, the US and its allies imposed a slew of economic sanctions on China and suspension of high-level political contacts with the country, which could potentially derail the country's Reform and Opening-Up Policy. These could also revive China's international isolation. Domestically, too, the Tiananmen incident led to the more conservative elements in the CPC trying to reverse some of the reforms and hold back on others. Li Peng as Premier did slow down the reforms, and there were renewed calls for economic self-reliance and stricter enforcement of ideological education and cultural controls. Nevertheless, Deng's great authority and prestige ensured that while there was some stalling, reforms did continue, particularly in the coastal provinces which were the chief beneficiaries of the new policies. Deng's well-publicized tour of the southern provinces in 1992 was aimed at reaffirming China's market-oriented growth strategies, in particular the setting up of SEZs.

Deng was also convinced that sheer profit motive would persuade Western companies invested in China to persuade their governments to eventually relax the sanctions. He reckoned that China was too large and growing a market to be ignored. His assessment proved right.

Despite the sanctions imposed on China, US President George Bush, Senior sent a secret mission under his National Security Advisor Brent Scowcroft soon afterwards, in July 1989, to assure Deng Xiaoping of American interest in continuing to forge a strong relationship with China. Bush may also have been influenced by the success of Gorbachev's visit to Beijing and the likelihood of revival of a China–Soviet partnership, which in turn could shrink the American room for manoeuvre. The decade of the 1990s proved to be a phase of very rapid growth for the Chinese economy, and it was the US which eased China's entry into the World Trade Organization (WTO) in 2001, enabling its full integration into the global